



HOW MUCH MONEY DO I ACTUALLY NEED TO BUY?

Before you start touring homes, break the numbers into 3 buckets:



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1. ESTIMATED DOWN PAYMENT

Your down payment depends on the loan program you qualify for.

Example on a **\$450,000** home:

Down Payment	Estimated Amount
3%	\$13,500
3.5%	\$15,750
5%	\$22,500
10%	\$45,000
20%	\$90,000

Eligible VA buyers may be able to purchase with 0% down. Certain buyers may also qualify for down payment assistance.

Your estimated purchase price: \$_____

Estimated down payment: \$_____

Your lender will confirm which loan programs and down payment options you qualify for.

2. ESTIMATED CASH TO CLOSE

Your down payment is only part of the money you may need.

Your estimated cash to close can include:

- ☐ Down payment
- ☐ Lender fees
- ☐ Appraisal
- ☐ Title and escrow costs
- ☐ Prepaid property taxes
- ☐ Homeowners insurance
- ☐ Mortgage insurance, when applicable
- ☐ Other transaction costs

Then subtract any applicable:

- Earnest money already deposited
- Seller credits
- Builder incentives
- Lender credits
- Approved assistance

Example

Purchase price: \$450,000
5% down: \$22,500
Estimated closing costs + prepaids: \$13,500
Earnest money already paid: -\$5,000
Seller credit: -\$5,000

Estimated Cash to Close:
\$26,000

Example only. Actual costs and credits vary significantly by loan, property, lender, insurance, taxes, and transaction.





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3. ESTIMATED MONTHLY PAYMENT

Don't look at just the mortgage.

Your total housing payment may include:

Principal + Interest

- \$_____

Property Taxes

- \$_____

Homeowners Insurance

- \$_____

Mortgage Insurance, if applicable

- \$_____

HOA, if applicable

- \$_____

Estimated Monthly Housing Payment:

\$_____ / month

Your lender can calculate this using your actual interest rate, loan program, credit profile, taxes, insurance, and property.



BEFORE YOU TOUR

Know these 3 numbers first:

1. Comfortable purchase price: \$_____

2. Estimated cash needed: \$_____

3. Comfortable monthly payment: \$_____

Your maximum approval amount does not automatically have to be your buying budget.

The goal is to find a home that works for your finances and your life, not simply the highest price you can qualify for.

Disclaimer: This worksheet is for general educational and planning purposes only and is not a loan estimate, pre-approval, or guarantee of financing. Actual down payment requirements, closing costs, monthly payments, interest rates, mortgage insurance, taxes, insurance, assistance programs, and qualification requirements vary. A licensed mortgage professional should provide financing estimates specific to your situation.



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